

KIT 8 OF 20 · 45–60 MINUTES · WHOLE STAFF · THE TRACK A CAPSTONE

Building Your School's AI Culture

Everything you need before you present. Read this once (about 8 minutes), run the 15-minute prep checklist, and you're ready. This one ends with a certificate.

What this session is

The capstone. Instead of building classroom artifacts, the faculty drafts the school's AI culture: **five norms in the building's own words, a sharing routine with a date and an owner, an onboarding plan covering every future hire, and next semester's rhythm**, all in a 20-minute lab run in small groups. The session names the fade risk honestly (the PD research identifies sustained routines and collaboration as what makes learning stick; we treat their absence as the fade risk), recruits the skeptics as quality control, and closes Track A with the AI-Ready Educator Certificate of Completion.

THE STANCE: REPEAT IT UNTIL IT'S FURNITURE

Culture is what keeps working when the PD ends. A tool becomes culture when nobody has to remember to use it.

Why the stakes are worth it: sustained routines and collaboration are what make PD stick (Darling-Hammond et al., 2017), while most schools' guidance still lags their adoption (RAND, 2025). Eight weeks of skills are currently stored in individual teachers; this hour moves them into systems.

Who should present it

Whoever ran the series, ideally, because this session spends its accumulated trust. Bring leadership into the room if at all possible: three moments (the no-refill promise, the no-surveillance line, and protecting the five minutes) land best endorsed live. What you must hold firmly: the lab output is real; the norms drafted today actually go to the faculty for signing this week, or the capstone was theater.

One prep item matters most: know your numbers. Open the staff prompt doc and count templates and contributors before the session; slide 9's story is your building's real library, and naming its actual numbers lands far better than Ms. Rivera's. Second: bring the exit-ticket stack (or its themes) from Kits 1–7; the recap on slide 2 should sound like this building, not a brochure. Third: decide who merges the norm drafts this week; it's a 30-minute job and it must have an owner before Friday.

The session at a glance

Segment	Minutes	What happens
What eight weeks built	0:00–0:06	The real inventory; the fade risk, named
What culture means	0:06–0:12	The watching test; five norms; win-fail-steal; the banner
The artifacts of culture	0:12–0:21	The staff doc (Ms. Rivera's screen); norms on one page; the calendar; triage practice
Sustaining it	0:21–0:30	New-hire plan; measuring without surveillance; tool churn; the certificate
Lab: draft the culture	0:30–0:52	Norms → routine calendared → onboarding + skeptics → semester rhythm
Making it stick	0:52–0:55	Inventory; honest limits; final commitments; Tracks B–D
First 48 hours & close	0:55–0:57	Action sheet + the last exit ticket + celebration

Core session is 57 minutes. For a 45-minute slot: two triage calls, lab steps 3–4 compressed to one block, two share-out voices; the script marks the cuts.

Your 15-minute prep checklist

- ☐ **Count the library** (3 min): templates and contributors in the staff doc; you'll say the real numbers on slide 9.
- ☐ **Skim Kits 1–7 exit-ticket themes** (3 min): the slide-2 recap should name this building's actual wins.
- ☐ **Name the norm-merger** (1 min): who turns four group drafts into one page this week.
- ☐ **Skim the script once** (5 min): the five norms on slide 6 and the certificate beat on slide 17 are the heart.
- ☐ **Print the handouts** (2 min): Participant Handout, First 48 Hours, Exit Ticket, one of each per person.
- ☐ **Chart paper or shared doc per group** (1 min): this lab drafts text, not prompts; devices optional.

Room, tech & timing

Groups of 3–4 (not pairs) for the lab; mixed departments beat department tables for norm-drafting. Wi-Fi optional. Timing discipline: the lab must start by 0:30; the norms step gets seven protected minutes. The things you never cut: slide 14 (no surveillance) and slide 16 (the never list). Expect real feeling at the certificate beat; some faculties applaud. Let them.

Facilitator FAQ

"Is this our official AI policy now?"

It's the school's working stance: real, posted, signed, and honored, until formal policy exists. When leadership builds policy properly (Kit 15 is the working session for it), the norms page is its seed. Interim stance beats no stance, and it beats a binder nobody read.

"What if leadership won't protect the routine?"

Then say so honestly at the reckoning: culture carried only by teachers burns the teachers. The session is designed to make the leadership asks small and public: five minutes protected, no refill, no surveillance. Small enough to grant on the spot; public enough to be remembered.

"Do resistant colleagues have to sign the norms?"

Invite, don't force. The norms bind the school's practice, not anyone's enthusiasm, and a skeptic who follows the privacy and review norms while doubting the hype is in full good standing; that's the skeptics-as-assets stance. Signature pressure creates quiet resentment; visible respect creates converts on their own schedule.

"What about the certificate for staff who missed a session?"

The kits re-run cheaply: any confident colleague can run a make-up for a small group with the same script, and the 45-minute cut works for make-ups. Completion means all eight experienced, not all eight attended on the original Tuesdays.

After the session: the capstone's checklist

- Collect the exit tickets: they complete Track A's documentation.
- Merge the norm drafts into one page this week; circulate for signing.
- Calendar the first sharing round with its named owner.
- Celebrate the certificate completion the way this building celebrates real things.

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